ROALLA



EXECUTIVE GROWTH LEADERSHIP DECISION GUIDE

Combining Executive Accountabilities Without Creating Leadership Gaps

Combine roles only where adjacency leverage capacity and control can be demonstrated

Prepared for founders, owners, boards, chief executives, investors and functional leaders in growth companies

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Status date: 25 October 2026

Purpose

This guide helps growth companies evaluate whether one executive can lead two or more functions, such as technology and product, operations and customer success, or marketing and revenue. It tests adjacency, capacity, conflicts, leadership depth and the conditions that should trigger a future split.

EXECUTIVE DECISION DASHBOARD

Management View at a Glance

Combined executive roles can improve alignment and reduce coordination cost at the right stage. They fail when the combination is title consolidation rather than coherent accountability design, or when urgent operational work consumes the executive capacity needed to lead both functions.

Executive question	ROALLA view	Decision implication
Is combining roles inherently risky?	**NO**	Risk depends on adjacency, capacity, control and leadership depth.
Does one title create one clear accountability?	**NO**	The underlying outcomes and decisions must still be explicit.
Can product and technology combine?	**CONDITIONAL**	It can work when customer and engineering leadership remain strong and distinct.
Should cost reduction drive the decision?	**NO**	Leadership leverage and enterprise outcomes should drive it.
What should management authorize now?	**PURSUE**	A combined-role viability test with split triggers.

Recommended Management Posture

Use the decision model to convert management confidence into verified evidence, explicit ownership and sequenced action. A weighted score supports prioritization, but a material hard-gate failure should override an attractive average.

Questions to Put to the Leadership Team

1. What shared outcome makes these functions genuinely adjacent?
2. What work would be dropped if one person held both roles?
3. Which conflicts require independent challenge?
4. Are strong functional leaders present beneath the role?
5. How will the scorecard detect imbalance?
6. Which peer interfaces must be redesigned?
7. What is the economic value beyond one salary?
8. What exact trigger causes the role to split?

EXECUTIVE DECISION MODEL

The Eight Combined Role Gates

These gates distinguish a needed executive accountability from an attractive title. Use them to test mandate, authority, capacity, interfaces and evolution before recruiting or reorganizing.

Stage	Gate	Required conclusion	Decision evidence
01	Outcomes	The combined mandate has coherent enterprise outcomes	Value, growth, service, economics and risk
02	Adjacency	The functions benefit from common leadership	Shared customers, workflows, data, capabilities and decisions
03	Capacity	One leader can perform both executive mandates	Time, span, cadence, travel and operating demand
04	Conflict	Competing interests are governable	Trade-offs, independent challenge and escalation
05	Depth	Strong functional leaders exist underneath	Delegation, expertise, succession and continuity
06	Interfaces	Other executives know where boundaries sit	CEO, finance, people and cross-functional decision rights
07	Economics	The model creates leverage rather than hidden cost	Speed, quality, compensation, bottlenecks and opportunity cost
08	Split	Exit triggers and transition are explicit	Scale, performance, risk, workload and talent signals

Decision Rule

A failed hard gate moves the initiative to Prepare or Monitor. A strong narrative, senior sponsor or attractive market cannot replace missing authority, evidence, delivery capacity or operating control.

SECTION 01

Readiness Framework

Translate ambition into a shared executive view of value, evidence, capability and risk.



MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT MODEL

Readiness Dimensions

No.	Decision area	Management evidence	Status
01	Strategic coherence	Shared outcomes and genuine functional adjacency	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
02	Executive capacity	Time, span, operating burden and decision load	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
03	Functional depth	Leaders, delegation, expertise and succession	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
04	Conflict controls	Trade-offs, independent challenge and escalation	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
05	Cross-functional interfaces	CEO and peer decision rights and forums	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
06	Evolution economics	Leverage, hidden cost, performance and split triggers	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**

Evidence Standard

Assessments should distinguish verified evidence from management confidence. Where evidence is incomplete, record the gap, owner, completion date and decision that depends on it.

STRATEGIC READINESS DEPENDENCIES

What Readiness Depends On

Dependency	Why it matters	Evidence management should expect
Outcomes	The combined mandate has coherent enterprise outcomes	Value, growth, service, economics and risk
Adjacency	The functions benefit from common leadership	Shared customers, workflows, data, capabilities and decisions
Capacity	One leader can perform both executive mandates	Time, span, cadence, travel and operating demand
Conflict	Competing interests are governable	Trade-offs, independent challenge and escalation
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ROALLA Interpretation

Dependencies should be evaluated as a connected system. A weakness in ownership, data, architecture, delivery or governance can change the economics and risk of an otherwise attractive initiative.

SECTION 02

Detailed Readiness Assessment

Convert executive intent into verifiable requirements, accountable evidence and clear remediation actions.



READINESS CHECKLIST

Combined Mandate Viability

Completion standard Mark Ready only when the supporting evidence has been verified. Assign an evidence owner to every open item.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
A01	The combination begins with enterprise outcomes rather than available people.	☐	☐	_____
A02	The functions share material customers, workflows, data or decisions.	☐	☐	_____
A03	Each functional mandate remains visible inside the combined role.	☐	☐	_____
A04	The executive's expected time allocation is realistic and reviewable.	☐	☐	_____
A05	Operational escalation patterns will not consume the entire role.	☐	☐	_____
A06	The leader has credible experience or supported capability in both domains.	☐	☐	_____
A07	Strong functional leaders can own daily execution below the executive.	☐	☐	_____
A08	Potential conflicts are identified before the role is approved.	☐	☐	_____
A09	Peers understand which cross-functional decisions belong to the combined executive.	☐	☐	_____
A10	The economic case includes delay, quality and key-person risk, not salary alone.	☐	☐	_____

READINESS CHECKLIST CONTINUED

Controls Measures and Split Triggers

Completion standard Use Gap to create a dated remediation action and identify the management decision that cannot proceed.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
B01	The role charter contains separate and shared outcomes for both functions.	☐	☐	_____
B02	Scorecards prevent one function from succeeding at the expense of the other.	☐	☐	_____
B03	Independent assurance exists where the executive would otherwise mark their own work.	☐	☐	_____
B04	Decision forums provide challenge on material trade-offs and investments.	☐	☐	_____
B05	Delegated authorities are documented for functional leaders.	☐	☐	_____
B06	The CEO reviews capacity and neglected-accountability signals at least quarterly.	☐	☐	_____
B07	Customer, employee and delivery indicators reveal imbalance early.	☐	☐	_____
B08	Succession plans protect both functions if the executive leaves.	☐	☐	_____
B09	Split triggers include scale, complexity, risk, performance and leadership readiness.	☐	☐	_____
B10	A transition plan identifies the future role that retains shared coordination.	☐	☐	_____

WEIGHTED EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Readiness Scorecard

Dimension	Weight	Evidence standard	Score	Status
Strategic coherence	20%	Shared outcomes and genuine functional adjacency	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Executive capacity	20%	Time, span, operating burden and decision load	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Functional depth	15%	Leaders, delegation, expertise and succession	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Conflict controls	15%	Trade-offs, independent challenge and escalation	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Cross-functional interfaces	15%	CEO and peer decision rights and forums	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Evolution economics	15%	Leverage, hidden cost, performance and split triggers	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
TOTAL	100%	Weighted executive assessment	__/100	Pursue / Prepare / Monitor

Decision Thresholds

Score	Posture	Management decision
75 to 100	**PURSUE**	Proceed to bounded execution subject to no hard-gate failure.
50 to 74	**PREPARE**	Complete a focused readiness plan before major commitment.
0 to 49	**MONITOR**	Resolve foundational gaps before investing further.

A single material hard-gate failure overrides the weighted score. ROALLA also applies judgment where administrative readiness is high but strategic value, adoption or commercial viability is weak.

SECTION 03

Execution and Advisory Roadmap

Build evidence and decision clarity before changing titles or recruiting. Use the first 90 days to prove the combined executive mandate in the company's real operating context.



Recommended 90 Day Mobilization

Timing	Focus	Key activities	Management output
Days 1 to 15	Clarify	Confirm growth objectives, current combined executive mandate, decision pressure and executive sponsor.	Approved diagnostic mandate
Days 16 to 35	Assess	Interview leaders, review evidence, map accountabilities and identify hard gaps.	Current-state evidence map
Days 36 to 55	Design	Develop practical options with mandate, interfaces, capacity, economics and risk.	Decision-ready options
Days 56 to 75	Validate	Test the preferred model through real decisions, management forums and team feedback.	Validated leadership model
Days 76 to 90	Mobilize	Approve owners, measures, communication, transition actions and review dates.	90-day activation plan

Twelve to Twenty Four Month Path

- Quarter 1: clarify the combined executive mandate, decision rights, interfaces and immediate capacity gaps.
- Quarter 2: embed management cadence, measures, delegation and leadership-team working practices.
- Quarters 3 and 4: adjust spans, roles and succession as scale and complexity increase.
- Year 2: review executive architecture against strategy, performance, risk and the next growth stage.

ROALLA ADVISORY MODEL

How ROALLA Can Help

ROALLA brings an independent transformation and technology perspective to leadership architecture. The objective is a leadership system that converts strategy into accountable decisions, scalable execution and measurable enterprise value.

ROALLA workstream	Executive value
Executive diagnostic	Assess strategy, growth stage, operating complexity, leadership load and material gaps.
Mandate design	Define outcomes, scope, authority, decision rights and explicit non-accountabilities.
Operating model	Align functions, forums, information flows, escalation paths and management cadence.
Technology and product alignment	Connect architecture, delivery, product, commercial and operational leadership.
Role and capacity options	Compare combined, fractional, interim and full-time structures using evidence.
Scorecards and incentives	Translate enterprise priorities into balanced executive outcomes and measures.
Selection and onboarding	Build role briefs, evaluation criteria, interview evidence and first-100-day plans.
Evolution assurance	Monitor effectiveness, challenge gaps and reset roles as strategy and scale change.

Recommended Initial Mandate

- Four-week executive structure and accountability diagnostic.
- Decision-rights map and leadership capacity assessment.
- Recommended combined executive mandate with role mandates, interfaces and transition risks.
- Executive readout and 90-day activation roadmap.

CONTROL FRAMEWORK

Key Risks and Controls

Risk	Exposure	ROALLA control
Convenience combination	The structure fits an incumbent rather than strategy.	Test the mandate independently of the person.
Capacity fiction	Two full roles are placed into one calendar.	Model workload and protect executive time.
Functional neglect	Urgency in one area starves the other.	Use balanced outcomes and leading indicators.
Conflict opacity	Trade-offs are decided without challenge.	Create escalation and assurance controls.
Weak layer below	The executive remains the daily operator.	Build functional leadership and delegation.
Key-person risk	Knowledge and authority become concentrated.	Document decisions and build succession.
Peer confusion	Other executives do not know boundaries.	Publish interfaces and decision rights.
Late split	The role persists after it stops working.	Use objective split triggers and reviews.

Professional Advice

Qualified legal, privacy, security, tax, accounting, employment and regulatory advisors should validate matters within their professional scope. ROALLA coordinates those inputs with technology strategy, architecture, commercialization, governance and transformation decisions.

OFFICIAL EVIDENCE BASE

Selected Official Sources

These sources support the management principles summarized in this guide. Standards, laws, guidance and organizational obligations continue to evolve and must be confirmed for the specific context before acting.

McKinsey The Big Product and Platform Shift. Official source — Research on leadership alignment, business and technology collaboration, talent and transformation execution.

McKinsey Products and Platforms Operating Model. Official source — Guidance on durable product and platform teams, end-to-end ownership, funding and outcome accountability.

Microsoft Cloud Adoption Framework RACI Alignment. Official source — Examples for assigning accountable, responsible, consulted and informed roles across strategy, governance, platforms and operations.

Advisory Disclaimer

This ROALLA guide is a strategic readiness and marketing document. It is not a certification, audit opinion, legal opinion, privacy opinion, security assurance, investment recommendation or guarantee of results. Management must validate current obligations, company facts and professional advice before making material decisions.